■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Friday, September 25, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■ *An HIV positive patient who had waited more than two years for a kidney received an organ in less than a week after joining a new HIV to HIV transplant program at Cedars Sinai. The hospital has now successfully performed its first HIV to HIV kidney and liver transplants*

The Angle: *A kidney patient who waited over two years got a transplant in under a week thanks to a groundbreaking HIV-to-HIV program — proof that a diagnosis that used to be a death sentence is now opening doors instead of closing them.*

- Patient waited **more than two years** on the standard transplant list
- Got matched and transplanted in **less than a week** after joining the new program
- Program is run by **Cedars-Sinai**
- Hospital has now completed its **first HIV-to-HIV kidney and liver transplants**

The Feel-Good Angle

- This is the kind of medical progress story that reminds you how far HIV treatment has come in one generation.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cedars-sinai.org/newsroom/surgeons-perform-cedars-sinais-first-hiv-to-hiv-organ-transplants/

■ *India, Nepal and Indonesia reported zero rhino poaching in 2025, marking a major conservation milestone for some of Asia's most threatened rhinos. The greater one-horned rhino population reached an estimated 4,075, with numbers continuing to grow in several protected areas.*

The Angle: *Three countries just posted a goose egg on rhino poaching, a species that's been hunted to the edge for its horn for decades — it's the kind of rare good-news conservation win that actually restores your faith in humanity for five minutes.*

- **India**, **Nepal**, and **Indonesia** all reported **zero rhino poaching incidents** in 2025.
- The greater one-horned rhino population is now estimated at **4,075** worldwide.
- Numbers are climbing in several protected reserves across the three countries.

The Feel-Good Moment

- Callers: what's the last piece of actual good news you saw in your feed this week?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.deccanherald.com/environment/wildlife/rhino-poaching-zero-in-india-nepal-and-indonesia-in-2025-but-habitat-challenge-remains-4143543

■ *White House leaves CNN off upcoming Trump trip on Air Force One*

The Angle: *The administration is freezing out a major network from the presidential press pool again, and this time it's got First Amendment red flags attached — a fight over who gets access to power that goes way beyond media-industry inside baseball.*

- The **White House** confirmed **Friday night** that **CNN** won't be aboard **Air Force One** for **Trump's Saturday trip**
- It's described as the **latest** in an **ongoing dispute** between the administration and the network

- Critics say the move raises **First Amendment** concerns about press access to the president

The Debate Starter

- Is freezing out a network from the press pool fair game for any White House, or does it cross a line on press freedom?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/white-house-cnn-trump-air-force-one-9.7359541?cmp=rss

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■■ *Liberal MP says he was demoted for supporting NDP bill targeting arms export controls*

The Angle: *A sitting government MP publicly accusing his own party of punishing him for a principled vote is exactly the kind of inside-baseball political drama that turns into a bigger story about party discipline versus conscience votes.*

- **Sean Casey**, the Liberal MP for **Charlottetown**, says he lost his job as parliamentary secretary to the **Minister of Veterans Affairs**
- He claims the demotion came after he voted against his own government
- The vote was in support of an **NDP private member's bill** targeting **arms export controls**
- Casey is going public with the claim, framing it as retaliation for breaking ranks

The Debate Starter

- Should MPs get punished for voting their conscience, or is toeing the party line just part of the job?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/casey-removed-israel-arms-bill-9.7359007?cmp=rss

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■■ *Canadian charged with voting fraud in the U.S. for casting ballot in 3 elections*

The Angle: *Election integrity is a live-wire topic right now, and a non-citizen allegedly gaming the system for years is exactly the kind of story that fuels the national debate over voter fraud and border security.*

- A **Canadian citizen** is facing charges for **voter fraud** in the U.S.
- Prosecutors say the person cast a ballot in **three separate elections**
- Case raises questions about how someone who isn't a U.S. citizen got registered to vote at all

The Debate Starter

- How does a non-citizen vote three times before anyone catches it - is this a one-off slip or a system-wide gap?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiuAFBVV95cUxQNzY5NFUwbFNkbHN1OTN2VGdGR1lqMnlLdklaNG5Db3czTGdBQW44d1ZTcjJYSEhRel9sZHVaOFhCdnVpWlY4M1BNb2o2LUFoMmRMV05ZSHBnRFZXQ3RQYTMtRjR0VjZTVlE0a0daZWc1QkVPWExyQlNTdGNvdUxGZ0ZtVmpEdDl6cC1EQ1hadlQtc3pkSWtKd0YtN1dleUo4S2pBUVUwWWR0eDRZZUNRbWl0MC1qNUFa?oc=5

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■ *Blue Jays all-star Guerrero Jr. apologizes for comments made in podcast interview*

The Angle: *A hometown all-star having to publicly apologize to his own fanbase mid-scrum is exactly the kind of awkward, human moment that gets a city talking - especially with the Jays fans invested in how he handles it.*

- **Vladimir Guerrero Jr.** apologized to **Blue Jays** fans on **Friday**
- He opened *and* closed the media scrum with the same apology
- The controversy stems from comments he made on a **Spanish-language podcast**

The Debate Starter

- Does a quick on-air apology actually fix it, or does bookending the scrum with 'sorry' just make it a bigger story?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/sports/baseball/mlb/vladimir-guerrero-jr-apology-contract-podcast-veronica-batista-9.7359222?cmp=rss

■ *There’s No Good Reason for Carney to Privatize Canada’s Airports - The plan would worsen labour conditions and make flying more expensive.*

The Angle: *There’s No Good Reason for Carney to Privatize Canada’s Airports - The plan would worsen labour conditions and make flying more expensive.*

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://thetyee.ca/Opinion/2026/09/22/No-Good-Reason-Carney-Privatize-Canada-Airports/

■ *AI 'slop' is dominating menus, as some restaurant owners turn to it to save time and money*

The Angle: *Canadian restaurant owners are leaning on AI to whip up menu descriptions and even dish names to save time and money, but the results are landing as awkward, overly-flowery "AI slop" that diners are starting to clock instantly.*

- **Restaurant owners** in Canada are using **AI tools** to generate menu copy to cut costs and save time
- The trend is being called **"AI slop"** by critics online
- Discussion is circulating on **r/canada** as diners start noticing the shift

The Debate Starter

- Can you actually tell when a menu description was written by AI, or has it gotten that good?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Read a real menu blurb** - 30 seconds -> Host reads a suspiciously over-the-top menu description on air and asks co-host to guess: human or AI?
- **Step 2: Callers guess the source** - 2-3 minutes, phone/text-in -> Play two menu descriptions back to back and have listeners text in which one was AI-written
- **Step 3: The tell-tale signs** - 1 minute wrap-up -> Hosts riff on the buzzwords that give away AI menu copy ("tantalizing," "symphony of flavors," etc.)

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/business/ai-generated-restaurant-images-9.7356958

Backup options:

■ *Marineland belugas that died in Chicago had chronic inflammatory disease, preliminary necropsy findings show*

The Angle: *Marineland has been under fire for years over animal welfare, so any update on what actually killed these belugas after they were shipped out of Canada is going to reignite that whole debate.*

- Belugas that had been moved from **Marineland** in Ontario died after arriving in **Chicago**
- **Preliminary necropsy findings** point to **chronic inflammatory disease** as the cause
- Marineland has faced ongoing scrutiny in Canada over the health and treatment of its marine mammals

The Debate Starter

- Does this let Marineland off the hook, or just confirm these animals were already in trouble before the move?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/marineland-beluga-deaths-preliminary-necropsy-findings-chicago-9.7358828?cmp=rss

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■ *EXCLUSIVE: RCMP arrest four in alleged Pearson drug smuggling bust*

The Angle: *This is a CTV News exclusive on an RCMP takedown at Canada's busiest airport, so people are going to want to know how something like this happens right under everyone's nose at Pearson.*

- **RCMP** made **four arrests** tied to an alleged drug smuggling operation.
- The bust is connected to **Toronto Pearson International Airport**.
- **CTV News** is reporting it as an exclusive, meaning more details are likely still coming out.

The Debate Starter

- How does an alleged smuggling ring operate out of one of the most heavily monitored airports in the country?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMimgFBVV95cUxNNUtEZlNRTGVsdXR1Y0E1aHhCdFB3dFRHMUNYQmNBVm12d1ktbkFqTEdfUE9wLTJBM09sSHdBZHVLbkRxTnN1MUs4SDBsMS14a1hwNWR5R05jVXdGMXdSYnlGbDFFdDVmMTB6Z3ZHdXpscnQ2ams1ZFlzbV9KOExGdk9KZHhpUGl6cHg3bExfckUyUEo3SnhjUlZR?oc=5

■ *9 Islamic schools on high alert after email threatening 'slaughter' of Muslims*

The Angle: *A hate-fueled threat against a religious community is always going to stop people in their tracks, and this one's got real families on edge right now, wondering if their kids are safe walking into school.*

- **9 Islamic schools** were placed on high alert after receiving a threatening email
- The email reportedly threatened to **'slaughter'** Muslims
- Story reported by **CTV News**

The Community Impact

- This isn't an abstract threat — it's real families deciding whether it's safe to send their kids to school this week.

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMitgFBVV95cUxPSDhPZVJiOTVCNGNuSHpXelM0TmpFVzU4N243ZlFvVHBQTWVfX2tCZ09SUVg0VHNjUEYyR2tIN01ZMlRCTklaWElDSGZXTVE1MzNGR0NaMVJ4MFowMXRiX2ZHLXQ2RmNJUmdTWGlWem5KZU9vQWVodVFOVnpZdDN5eENZcGdDRTdtcjhtdzVYbWd3d1ZxdjV4Q0tidDBzVnAyQVZWajB2a0txMjNDSHNPWW42d2Vndw?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Marisa Tomei, 61, Says She Doesn't Go to the Gym. Her Simple Secret to Looking So Good (Exclusive) - People.com*

The Angle: *Everyone's obsessed with anti-aging hacks right now, and a 61-year-old Oscar winner saying she skips the gym entirely is the kind of counterintuitive celebrity confession that gets people talking about what actually works.*

- **Marisa Tomei** is **61 years old**
- She says she **doesn't go to the gym** to stay in shape
- She's sharing her "simple secret" to looking good in a **People** exclusive

The Phone-In Trigger

- What's your no-gym secret to staying in shape — call in and brag about it.

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Guess Her Secret** - 30 seconds before the reveal -> Each host guesses what Marisa Tomei's "simple secret" actually is before saying what People reported
- **Step 2: Trade Your Own Hack** - After the reveal -> Hosts share their own no-gym trick for staying fit, then open phones for listeners to do the same

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMipwFBVV95cUxOckZzel81RjVmOXBaNEpDR3A3ZWRfcVZJWjJQdHZuVFdGNTRuYS1ibVNQZEc0REY5ajE0TGF4a1FvdnBYY2w0bUlHaXl5bXZYaGtFR3FqLVRRZFM4a2JFTC00bUIzQXF0UGRFVG9OS1BDWEYyWWk0ZU9rN3FIU3BzVFExNWtwVXhuQWVPVVNGLW1NakRiaWgxSG9yUVJBdU5PaHdpN1Exdw?oc=5

■ *Ed Sheeran's upcoming shows at Robert Kraft's Gillette Stadium have been cancelled due to bad weather*

The Angle: *Weather just torched a stop on one of the biggest pop tours going right now, leaving a stadium full of fans scrambling for refunds or reschedule dates - always good drama for a slow entertainment day.*

- **Ed Sheeran**'s shows at **Gillette Stadium** were cancelled
- **Gillette Stadium** is owned by Patriots owner **Robert Kraft**

- Reason given: bad weather

The Watercooler Take

- Ever had a concert get rained out on you - refund, reschedule, or just bad luck?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/zn9xviz0horh1.jpeg

■ *Taylor Swift's 'TLOAS: Encore Edition' Review | "She no longer has the incentive to take creative risks. No producer or record label boss would dare offer a critical opinion. It's a crying shame. Modern pop's greatest voice risks rubbishing her own legacy because she's scared to take a day off."*

The Angle: *A major UK critic is saying what a lot of fans are whispering — that Taylor's non-stop release schedule is starting to hurt her instead of help her, which is exactly the kind of hot take that splits a fanbase.*

- The review is of **'The Life of a Showgirl: Encore Edition'**
- Critic's line: **"No producer or record label boss would dare offer a critical opinion"**
- Calls her **"modern pop's greatest voice"** but says she's **"scared to take a day off"**
- Warns she risks **"rubbishing her own legacy"** by not taking creative risks

The Debate Starter

- Is Taylor Swift too big to be told no anymore — and is that actually hurting her music?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/gallery/1wpw45q

■ *Taylor Swift dropped 4 new songs. Here's what fans are sleuthing*

The Angle: *Any new Taylor Swift material sends the internet into instant lyric-decoding overdrive, and this reissue is no different — it's a guaranteed conversation starter for anyone with a Swiftie in their life.*

- **Taylor Swift** just released **The Life of a Showgirl: The Encore**, an extended version of her **2025 album**.
- The reissue adds **four brand new tracks** fans hadn't heard before.
- Fans immediately went into **"full-blown CSI"** mode, sleuthing the lyrics for hidden meanings and Easter eggs.

The Sleuth Session

- Call in: what's your wildest theory about who these new tracks are actually about?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Cold Read the Lyrics** - 60 seconds, no prep -> Hosts each read a line from one of the new tracks and guess who or what it's about before looking anything up.
- **Step 2: Compare to the Swiftie Theories** - Reveal -> Pull up what fans online are already theorizing and see who was closer, host or internet.
- **Step 3: Phone Line Verdict** - Caller vote -> Ask listeners to call in and settle which theory is most believable.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/taylor-swift-life-of-a-showgirl-encore-deluxe-extended-swifties-9.7358607?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *If 'Kamen Rider' and 'Parasyte' Did a Fusion Dance, It'd Come Out Looking Like 'Jagaaan'*

The Angle: *Before he blew up with soccer anime 'Blue Lock,' this creator wrote a wild body-horror manga that's finally getting an English release - perfect timing for Halloween and a fun 'wait, THAT guy wrote this?' angle for anime fans.*

- **Muneyuki Kaneshiro**, the creator behind mega-hit **'Blue Lock,'** wrote this manga before he was famous
- The title is **'Jagaaan'** - described as a mashup of **'Kamen Rider'** and **'Parasyte'** vibes
- It's getting an official **English release timed for Halloween**
- Reviewers are calling it **'gleefully unhinged'** horror

The Watercooler Angle

- You never guess your favorite creator's origin story - ask listeners what pop culture 'before they were famous' surprise blew their mind.

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/jagaaan-manga-review-volume-1-horror-sci-fi-muneyuki-kaneshiro-blue-lock-2000817573

■ *'Hanuman Ansh' Indian Sleeper Hit's International Distribution Strategy Unveiled by 'K.G.F,' 'Kantara' Outfit Hombale Films (EXCLUSIVE)*

The Angle: *Indian cinema keeps quietly conquering the world outside Bollywood, and the same producers behind global hits K.G.F. and Kantara just pulled off another international breakout - proof this isn't a fluke, it's a strategy.*

- **Hanuman Ansh** has pulled in more than **$3.5 million** outside its home market in India
- The distributor is **Hombale Films**, the studio behind blockbuster franchises **K.G.F.** and **Kantara**
- It's written and directed by **Vishal Chaturvedi**, adapted from his own book **"Divine Detour"**
- Hombale is now going public with exactly how it engineered the international run

The Crossover Take

- Indian films keep out-hustling half of Hollywood overseas - are we finally paying attention to that?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/hanuman-ansh-indian-sleeper-hit-hombale-films-strategy-1236876199/

■ *Scarlett Johansson Takes Break From Filming Overseas for 'Paper Tiger' NYFF Premiere After Skipping Cannes: 'I'm Hallucinating'*

The Angle: *She skipped Cannes for this movie, then flew straight off an overseas film set to make the New York Film Festival premiere — and walked the carpet basically sleepwalking. It's a relatable "I'm running on fumes" moment from an A-lister that's easy, fun tape.*

- **Scarlett Johansson** reunited with co-stars **Adam Driver** and **Miles Teller** for the **NYFF** premiere of **"Paper Tiger"**
- The premiere kicked off the festival's **64th edition**
- She'd just gotten off a long international flight from another film shoot: **"I'm hallucinating,"** she said
- She'd already skipped the **Cannes** premiere for this same movie

The Relatable Bit

- Callers: what's the most jet-lagged, out-of-body thing you've ever done for work right after a flight?

variety.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/festivals/scarlett-johansson-paper-tiger-new-york-film-festival-premiere-adam-driver-1236872284/

■■ *Julia Haart's ex husband facing criminal charges, jail over actions during brutal divorce*

The Angle: *The 'My Unorthodox Life' star's nasty divorce just got a wild new chapter — her ex is now facing actual criminal charges, even after they settled the money fight.*

- **Julia Haart** and ex-husband **Silvio Scaglia** already settled their **$90 million** divorce split
- Despite the settlement, **Scaglia** is now facing **criminal charges** tied to how he handled the divorce
- Reports say he could be looking at **jail time** over his actions during the split

The Debate Starter

- A $90 million settlement usually ends the drama — so what did he do that's serious enough for criminal charges?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://pagesix.com/2026/09/25/society/julia-haarts-ex-husband-facing-criminal-charges-jail-over-alleged-actions-during-brutal-divorce/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Why the viral clip of 'multitasking mom' at a baseball game has enraged people online*

The Angle: *A photo of a mom at a ballgame with a baby strapped on, a diaper bag on her back, and her hands full of snacks turned into an instant Rorschach test for how we talk about motherhood — some see a superhero, others see a symbol of an unfair load, and the internet can't agree.*

- Viral clip shows a mom at a **Major League Baseball game** with a **baby strapped to her chest**, a **diaper bag on her back**, and her **arms full of food**
- The image has been called an accidental **metaphor for the mental and physical load mothers carry**
- Story is being framed as "**why it's enraged people online**" — the reaction itself has become the story

The Debate Starter

- Is this mom a superhero flexing on everyone, or proof moms get zero help at family outings — where do you land?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/multitasking-mom-broadcast-giants-twins-major-league-baseball-9.7358097?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *Ella Langley goes viral after rejecting fan who asked her out https://t.co/1i8qwk7HcR https://t.co/GbOd8Y3UxJ*

The Angle: *A country star's blunt reply to a fan's flirty DM-turned-public moment is blowing up online, and it's the exact kind of celebrity-meets-regular-person internet moment that gets everyone talking about how they'd have handled it.*

- **Ella Langley** is going viral after publicly shutting down a fan who asked her out
- The moment was picked up and amplified by **The New York Post**
- Reaction is spreading fast online, with the exchange itself doing the talking

The Debate Starter

- Was Ella Langley's rejection savage or totally fair — callers, how would you want to be shot down?

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2103647302548160705

■■ *Backlash as Indian oil heir made professor of sustainability by Newcastle University*

The Angle: *It's got that perfect 'you can't make this up' irony that r/nottheonion lives for - a university handing a green credibility badge to someone whose family fortune comes from oil is exactly the kind of hypocrisy story that gets phones ringing.*

- **Newcastle University** appointed the heir to an **Indian oil fortune** as a professor of sustainability
- The move has sparked **backlash** online, with critics calling out the apparent contradiction
- Story is circulating widely on **r/nottheonion**, a subreddit dedicated to real news that reads like satire

The Hypocrisy Meter

- Does money buy you a green reputation no matter where it came from - discuss.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.aol.co.uk/articles/indian-oil-gas-heir-made-102644000.html

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Higher overall disgust sensitivity was associated with a greater likelihood of identifying as a Republican and holding a conservative ideology. A person with high disgust sensitivity and*

low bodily awareness had a 64.1% probability of identifying as a Republican.

The Angle: *New psych research ties how easily disgusted you are to your politics — it's a fun, low-stakes personality-quiz hook that gets people arguing about themselves instead of the news cycle.*

- Study found **higher overall disgust sensitivity** was linked to a **greater likelihood of identifying as Republican** and holding a **conservative ideology**.
- People with **high disgust sensitivity + low bodily awareness** had a **64.1% probability** of identifying as Republican.
- Posted to **r/science**, sparking chatter over whether gut-level reactions (literally) predict political leanings.

The Debate Starter

- On a scale of 'meh' to 'I might throw up,' how grossed out do you get — and does it match your politics?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Gross-Out Test** - Cold open, 60 seconds -> Hosts each rate 1-10 how disgusted they'd be by a few scenarios (moldy leftovers, stepping in gum barefoot, a stranger's cough on your hand).
- **Step 2: The Reveal** - After both scores are in -> Read the study finding out loud and have each host guess where their score would place them politically before saying their actual leaning.
- **Step 3: Open the Lines** - Caller/text segment -> Ask listeners to text their gross-out score (1-10) plus their political lean, no names, and read a few live to see if the pattern holds.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.psypost.org/disgust-predicts-conservative-views-most-strongly-in-people-with-low-bodily-awareness/

Backup options:

■ ***A large study says a higher amount of midlife visceral fat is strongly linked to increased brain inflammation and early biological signs of Alzheimer's disease up to 20 years before memory symptoms appear.***

The Angle: *This hits home for anyone in midlife - it's not just about how your gut looks, it's a warning sign for Alzheimer's showing up decades before memory loss ever would.*

- A large study links higher **midlife visceral fat** - the deep belly fat around your organs - to increased **brain inflammation**.
- Researchers found early biological markers of **Alzheimer's disease** tied to that fat, showing up **up to 20 years** before memory symptoms hit.
- The scary part: this damage may be quietly building in your **40s and 50s**, long before anyone notices a problem.

The Waistline Wake-Up Call

- Would you actually want to know your Alzheimer's risk 20 years early, even if there's not much you can do about it yet?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.psypost.org/midlife-belly-fat-is-linked-to-elevated-alzheimer-s-biomarkers-decades-later/

■ ***For most Americans with private health insurance, hospital prices are not set by government, but by hospitals and insurers who negotiate over how much an insurer will pay. Patients and families are regularly caught in the middle as hospitals and insurers negotiate better deals for themselves.***

The Angle: *Almost everyone with private insurance has been blindsided by a medical bill, and this gets at why: the price isn't set by law or by your doctor, it's a backroom deal between your hospital and your insurer — and you're the one stuck holding the tab when they don't agree.*

- For most Americans on **private insurance**, hospital prices are **not government-set** — they're negotiated between **hospitals and insurers**.
- Those negotiations happen out of the patient's view, with each side pushing for the better deal.

- When talks between a hospital and an insurer break down, it's **patients and families** who end up caught in the middle.

The Rant Trigger

- Ever gotten a hospital bill that made zero sense? Call in — we want your worst medical billing horror story.

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://sph.brown.edu/news/2026-09-24/public-brinkmanship

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CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES (franchise fallback)

■ *Germany pledges to phase out fossil fuels for first time with target of 2045.*

The Angle: *Germany is Europe's industrial powerhouse and its biggest polluter, so a real 2045 fossil fuel phase-out target is a genuinely big deal - it's the kind of concrete climate deadline most countries talk about but never commit to on paper.*

- **Germany** has pledged to phase out fossil fuels entirely for the first time in its history
- The target date is **2045** - a full 5 years ahead of the EU's broader 2050 net-zero goal
- It marks a shift from vague climate promises to an actual, dated national commitment

The Good News Wrap

- One of the world's biggest economies just put a hard deadline on quitting fossil fuels - name one other country you think could actually pull that off.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theguardian.com/environment/2026/sep/23/germany-commits-for-first-time-to-phasing-out-fossil-fuels-by-2045

Backup options:

■ *BetBolt Says It Paid Bonnie Blue $1.2M to Name Her Baby to Turn Her 'Porn Addict' Fans Into Gambling Addicts*

The Angle: *This is the kind of headline that sounds fake until you read it twice — a gambling brand openly admitting it's using an adult creator's fanbase to recruit new bettors, baby name and all.*

- Betting company **BetBolt** says it paid content creator **Bonnie Blue $1.2 million** for the rights to name her baby.
- The stated goal, per the company itself: convert her **'porn addict' fans** into **gambling addicts**.
- Story surfaced on **r/nottheonion** — the subreddit for real news too absurd to look real.

The 'You Can't Make This Up' Moment

- Phone line question: what would YOU let a brand name for a million bucks?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Name That Price** - 60-90 second live bit -> Hosts each name one thing in their life (pet, car, firstborn's middle name) they'd sell naming rights to, and for how much.
- **Step 2: Take Callers** - Open phones -> Ask listeners to call in with their own 'what would you let a brand name' price tag — funniest/most outrageous answer wins bragging rights.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.medicaldaily.co.uk/betbolt-bonnie-blue-baby-naming-deal-1759168

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/5 this month; TECH TALK 3/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *France unveils plan to ditch all fossil fuels by 2050.*

The Angle: *A G7 country just put a hard deadline on ending oil, gas, and coal entirely, which puts pressure on every other major economy watching to see if it's actually doable.*

- **France** has unveiled a plan to eliminate **all fossil fuel use** by **2050**.
- The announcement positions France as one of the most aggressive major economies on a full fossil fuel phase-out timeline.

The Debate Starter

- Is 2050 a real deadline or just a headline politicians won't be around to answer for?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/climate-and-environment/article/france-unveils-plan-to-ditch-all-fossil-fuels-by-2050/

■ *A Sydney factory roof combines 319 solar panels with 14,000 native plants, and the living roof makes the panels produce 11.1% more electricity in summer while running up to 28°C cooler. It also retains 73% of stormwater and supports 39 species, including 13 pollinators.*

The Angle: *It's the ultimate solar-punk mashup — solar panels and a mini native jungle sharing the same roof in Sydney, and the plants actually make the panels work better. It's a feel-good climate win that sounds almost too clever to be real.*

- The roof combines **319 solar panels** with **14,000 native plants**
- The greenery keeps panels running up to **28°C cooler**, boosting summer output by **11.1%**
- It soaks up **73% of stormwater** that would otherwise run off
- The setup supports **39 species**, including **13 pollinators**

The Watercooler Angle

- Would you put a wildflower meadow on your roof if it meant a cheaper power bill?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.autonocion.com/us/sydney-roof-14000-plants-319-solar-panels/

■ *'Temu Rachel Dolezal': Philly activist confesses to years of identity fraud faking Black and Palestinian heritage*

The Angle: *It's a real-life 'Rachel Dolezal' sequel, and those stories always blow up because everyone has an opinion on identity, authenticity, and why someone would lie about their race for years without getting caught.*

- A **Philadelphia** activist has publicly confessed to faking **Black and Palestinian heritage** for years.
- The internet has already slapped a nickname on her: the **'Temu Rachel Dolezal.'**
- It's a direct callback to the infamous **2015 Rachel Dolezal** scandal, where a white NAACP chapter leader was exposed for passing as Black.

The Debate Starter

- Why do these 'identity fraud' stories keep happening, and does faking a marginalized identity actually help anyone get ahead?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.nbcnews.com/news/us-news/philly-activist-confesses-faking-black-palestinian-roots-rcna599298

BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *Not just a trip: LSD can improve motor skills*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Rides the psychedelic-medicine research trend with a genuinely surprising, counter-intuitive finding (motor skills, not just perception) that's easy to headline and share.
The Angle: *New research flips the classic 'tripping' stereotype into a real science story, suggesting LSD could sharpen coordination — the kind of surprising, counterintuitive finding that's easy watercooler fodder.*

- New research suggests **LSD** isn't just about the psychedelic 'trip' - it may also boost **motor skills**.
- It's part of a growing wave of science taking a serious look at **psychedelics** for potential medical benefits, not just recreational use.
- The framing itself is the hook: a drug long dismissed as purely recreational getting a legitimate performance angle.

The Debate Starter

- If science backs it up, does that change how you personally think about psychedelics?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.swissinfo.ch/eng/various/taking-lsd-isnt-just-about-tripping-it-improves-motor-skills/92117098?utm_source=multiple&utm_medium=website&utm_campaign=news_en&utm_content=o&utm_term=wpblock_highlighted-compact-news-carousel

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■ *Runa Khan started Friendship in 2002 with one floating hospital to help Bangladesh's poorest communities. It now has seven hospital ships, serves 7.5 million people a year and has helped create 205,000 jobs. After 25 years, Khan has won Asia's Ramon Magsaysay Award.*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Classic against-all-odds founder story with concrete, staggering scale numbers (one boat to seven hospital ships, 7.5M people/year) that gives it a strong emotional payoff arc.
The Angle: *A woman who started with a single floating clinic just won one of Asia's biggest humanitarian honors - a feel-good reminder that one person's idea can snowball into something massive over 25 years.*

- **Runa Khan** launched **Friendship** back in **2002** with just one floating hospital
- That single boat has grown into a fleet of **seven hospital ships**
- The organization now serves **7.5 million people** every year
- Along the way it's helped create **205,000 jobs** - and Khan just won the **Ramon Magsaysay Award**

The Feel-Good Follow-Up

- One boat, 25 years, 7.5 million people helped - what's the smallest idea you've seen turn into something huge?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thedailystar.net/news/news/friendships-runa-khan-gets-ramon-magsaysay-award-4260981

■ *It's officially Dolly Parton Day, with parades, pink lights and book drives - September 25, 2026*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Lands on the actual calendar date (Sept 25) with built-in real-world activations (parades, book drives), and the fact that an unrelated Twitter account independently posted the same peg suggests organic momentum forming across platforms.
The Angle: *Dolly Parton is basically America's honorary grandma at this point, and now it's official - a whole day built around parades, pink lights, and giving back. It's the kind of pure, feel-good story that's perfect to close the show on.*

- **September 25** is now officially **Dolly Parton Day**
- Celebrations reportedly include **parades** in her honor
- Landmarks are lighting up **pink** for the occasion
- The day is tied to **book drives**, echoing her famous literacy work

The Feel-Good Finish

- If you got your own day, what color would the whole town light up for you?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://apnews.com/article/dolly-parton-day-925-1741a56d5a32ed562c465352ee9e2f40

■ *ICE accused of using "burrito" restraint on immigrants as punishment*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The specific, visceral detail ('burrito' restraint) is a sticky, quotable hook layered onto the highly charged, already-trending immigration enforcement story.
The Angle: *It's the kind of headline that sounds fake but isn't — a real allegation about detainee treatment wrapped in the most absurd possible name, which is exactly why it's blowing up on r/nottheonion.*

- **ICE** is facing accusations of using a so-called **"burrito" restraint** — tightly wrapping detainees in a blanket or sheet — as a punishment, not a safety measure.
- The headline is making the rounds on **r/nottheonion**, the subreddit dedicated to real news too ridiculous-sounding to believe.

The Face-Palm Headline

- Somebody in ICE's press office is having a very bad day over this one.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.the-independent.com/news/world/americas/aclu-ice-wrap-restraint-lawsuit-b3056523.html

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■ *For months, OpenAI's agent swarms have been attacking online databases to find obscure facts*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The 'AI agents attacking databases' framing taps directly into the current agentic-AI anxiety cycle with a novel, slightly alarming angle that outlets love to amplify.
The Angle: *This taps into the growing backlash against AI companies quietly scraping the internet at scale — it's a real flashpoint for anyone who runs a website or just wonders what's fueling these chatbots behind the scenes.*

- Reports say **OpenAI's** AI "agent swarms" have been hitting online databases **for months**
- The stated goal: digging up **obscure, niche facts** most humans would never bother searching for
- Raises the bigger question of who's paying the bandwidth bill when AI bots scrape sites at scale

The Debate Starter

- If an AI bot is hammering a small website thousands of times a day just to learn trivia, who should be on the hook for that traffic?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/25/for-months-openais-agent-swarms-have-been-attacking-online-databases-to-find-obscure-facts/

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Lady wtf, your kid is right there!" (X/Twitter @WomenBeingAwful, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Channing Tatum addresses claims he trolled ex Zoë Kravitz online using burner account: ‘Wtf come on’" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-22)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 19 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)
- "Rachael Leigh Cook surprises fans at ‘Josie and the Pussycats’ 25th anniversary screening" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-09-07)
- "Stevie Wonder Announces ‘Songs in the Key of Life’ 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)

- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani’s toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live’s 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)
- "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations" (The Globe and Mail (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Universal Studios Japan Celebrates Halloween With First R-Rated Attraction" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-13)
- "‘Practical Magic 2’ Dazzles Up a Bit Of an Audience" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-09-14)
- "The London revival of “Sunday in the Park With George” has been canceled following the exits of stars Ariana Grande and Jonathan Bailey." (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "'Sunday in the Park With George' London Revival Canceled After Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey Exits https://t.co/cPQ2IIvYql" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-14)
- "‘Sunday in the Park With George’ revival scrapped after Ariana Grande, Jonathan Bailey exits" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-09-14)
- "Margot Robbie stuns in a retro bikini as she joins shirtless Bradley Cooper to shoot the Ocean's Eleven 1960s prequel on the French Riviera" (www.dailymail.co.uk, banked 2026-09-16)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-20)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-22)
- "1Retro adds cloud saves to RetroArch, OpenEmu, and other gaming platforms" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-09-22)
- "NCT 127 Open 10th-Anniversary ‘Neo City: The Redline’ Tour With Sold-Out Seoul Run" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-23)
- "‘The Visit’ at Pasadena Playhouse Review: The ’50s Absurdist Comedy Is Too Smug in Its Peak-Bleak View of Venal Humanity, but Jefferson Mays and Melinda Page Hamilton Are Worth the Visit" (variety.com, banked 2026-09-23)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- @Billboard (fetch failed)
- Morning Brew (OpenCLI browser-scrape returned nothing - check Chrome/bridge)
- 3 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-26 12:25 AM